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Siers battery three-movers

by C.G.S.Narayanan

In a two-move chess problem, the frontal piece of a white battery opens up discovered check from the rear piece which invariably ends up in mate. But in a three or more-mover the frontal piece has more scope for further play. In Siers battery the frontal piece when discovering check grants a flight to the black king and after the king moves to the flight the frontal piece checks or mates while the rear piece takes care of the BK's original square.

The white knight is by far the most popular frontal piece in Siers battery due to its power to reach more squares than any other piece. The first example below is a task record of eight thematic variations.

Nils van Dijk

I prize, The Problemist 1965



Mate in three moves

Key 1.Bd2! (threat 2.Na7+ Kd4 3.Nxd5); 1...Qb3 2.Na5+ Kd4 3.Nxb3 1...Qc4 2.Nb4 Kd4 3.Nxc2; 1...Bxf5 2.Ne7+ Kd4 3.Nxf5; 1...c4 2.Nd8+ Kd4 3.Ne6; 1...Bxc3 2.Ne5+ Kd4/Kxe5 3.Nf3/Bxc3; 1...Bd4 2.Nb8+ Ke5 3.Nd7; 1...Bxf6 2.Nd4+Kxd4/Ke5 3.Qxf6/Nf3 Each time black king plays to d4 a different mate results.

The second by the famous duo from Netherlands adds a new dimension to the Siers where interposition of pieces instead of granting King flight gives

scope for pin mates. The key threatens Nc2+ and after interposition on d4 the other knight mates on d6. The two black defences cross over critical square d4 but result in attractive pin mates after the blockade on d4.

H.Le Grand & P Le Grand
I prize, Schach Echo 1956

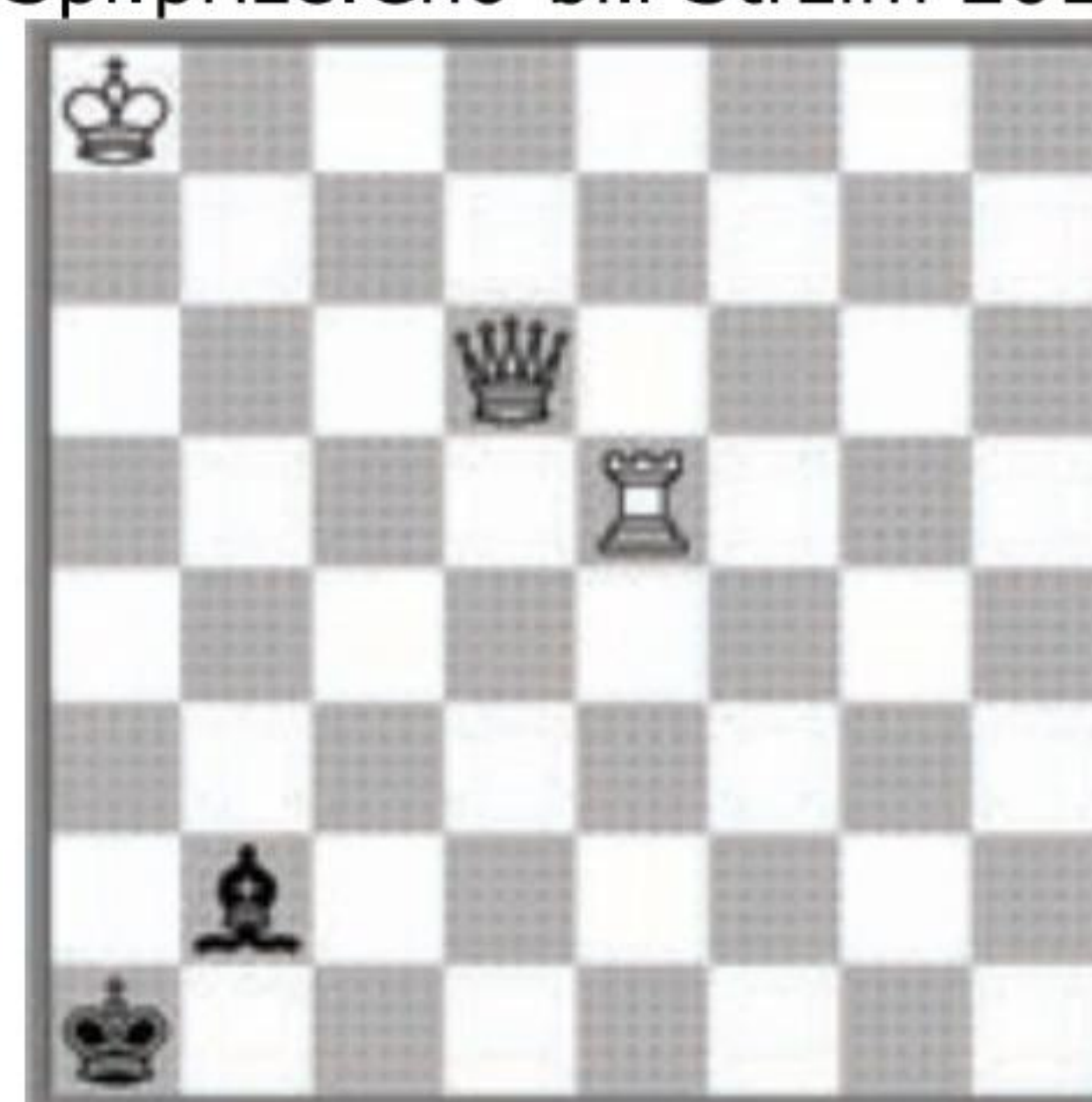


Mate in three moves

Key 1.Ra4! (2.Nc2+ Bd4/Qd4 3.Nd6) 1...Qc5 2.Nd3+Bd4/Qd4 3.Nf2 mate 1...Be5 2.Na2+! Bd4/Qd4 3.Nc3 mate

The white knight chooses its destination carefully for the pin mate. Finally a miniature (problem with seven men or less) where the strong WQ needs WR to deliver mate.

Christian Poisson
Spl.prize.Cno-bill Strzim 2010



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article "Strategic reversal of mates": Set: 1...Qxd3 Rb4(A); 1...Qxf5 2.Re7(B) Key 1.Bg5 1...Qxd3 2.Re7(B); 1...Qxf5 2.Rb4(A)

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com